Vegetables, whole fruits and protein-rich foods can support a healthy diet. Whether they help with weight loss or gain depends mainly on your total portions, cooking method and overall calorie intake. No single food automatically burns fat or causes weight gain.

Below covers the vegetables and fruits in your recipe collection, several common additions, and all the meats you requested. I've interpreted **"troat fish" as trout**.

How to read the tables:

- **Weight loss:** Foods that provide volume, fibre or protein for relatively few calories.
- **Weight gain:** Foods that make it easier to increase calories, especially when combined with adequate protein.
- **Either:** Useful for either goal when portions match your needs.

Vegetables and their benefits

Vegetable	Main nutritional benefits	Weight goal and other uses
Spinach	Folate, vitamin K, carotenoids and some iron. Supports normal blood formation and eye health.	**Weight loss:** low in calories and adds volume. Its iron is less readily absorbed than meat iron; lemon or tomatoes help absorption.
Collard greens and kale / haakh	Vitamins K and C, carotenoids, fibre and calcium.	**Weight loss:** filling when cooked with modest oil. Useful for bone health and bowel regularity.
Turnip greens and radish greens	Vitamins K and C, folate and carotenoids.	**Weight loss:** nutritious, low-calorie greens. Wash thoroughly before cooking.
Fenugreek leaves / methi	Fibre, folate and carotenoids.	**Weight loss:** adds flavour and volume. A normal food serving is useful, but it is not a treatment for diabetes.
Edible mallow / sochal	Fibre, carotenoids and vitamin C; amounts vary by species.	**Weight loss:** low-calorie leafy vegetable. Use correctly identified edible leaves.
Sorrel	Vitamin C, carotenoids and a naturally sour flavour.	**Weight loss:** low in calories. High in oxalates, so large portions may be unsuitable for people prone to calcium-oxalate kidney stones.
Lotus stem / nadru	Fibre, vitamin C and potassium; contains more starch than leafy greens.	**Either:** boiled or stewed lotus stem can fit a weight-loss diet. Deep-fried nadru is much more calorie-dense.
Kohlrabi / monj	Vitamin C, fibre and potassium. Its leaves also provide vitamin K and carotenoids.	**Weight loss:** good volume for relatively few calories.

Vegetable	Main nutritional benefits	Weight goal and other uses
Turnip root / shalgam	Vitamin C, fibre and water.	**Weight loss:** a lower-calorie alternative to some of the potato in a meal.
White radish / muji	Water, vitamin C and some fibre.	**Weight loss:** useful in salads, stews and yogurt dips. Does not "detox" the body or burn fat.
Eggplant / brinjal / vangun	Fibre and, particularly in the skin, plant pigments called anthocyanins.	**Weight loss when roasted or stewed.** It absorbs considerable oil when fried.
Potato	Carbohydrate for energy, potassium, vitamin C and some fibre, especially with the skin.	**Either:** boiled potatoes can be filling during weight loss. Larger portions support weight gain or higher activity needs. Fries and rich dum aloo contain much more fat.
Tomato	Vitamin C, potassium and lycopene. Cooking improves lycopene availability.	**Weight loss:** useful for adding flavour and volume to sauces with little oil.
Carrot	Beta-carotene, which the body can convert to vitamin A, plus fibre.	**Weight loss:** useful raw or cooked. Supports normal vision; it does not correct every cause of poor eyesight.
Pumpkin	Carotenoids, water, potassium and some fibre.	**Weight loss:** relatively low-calorie when steamed, roasted or stewed. Halwa has a different calorie profile.
Bottle gourd	Mostly water, with small amounts of fibre and micronutrients.	**Weight loss:** a light vegetable for stews. **Discard unusually bitter bottle gourd; do not consume its juice.**
Ridge gourd / turai	Water, some fibre and vitamin C.	**Weight loss:** useful for light meals when prepared with modest oil.
Bitter gourd / karela	Vitamin C, fibre and folate.	**Weight loss:** low in calories. It does not replace blood-sugar medication.
Okra / bhindi	Fibre, including soluble fibre, plus folate and vitamin C.	**Weight loss:** helps make meals filling. Soluble fibre supports bowel health and healthy cholesterol levels.
Cauliflower	Vitamin C, folate and fibre.	**Weight loss:** adds substantial volume. Can replace part of a rice or potato portion if desired.
Cabbage	Vitamins C and K and fibre.	**Weight loss:** inexpensive, filling and low in calories. There is no special fat-burning effect from cabbage soup.
Green peas	More protein and starch than most vegetables, plus fibre and folate.	**Either:** helpful for fullness, energy and increasing plant protein.
Beetroot	Folate, fibre and dietary nitrates.	**Either:** fits weight-loss meals. Nitrates may modestly support blood pressure and exercise performance.

Vegetable	Main nutritional benefits	Weight goal and other uses
Cucumber	Water and small amounts of vitamin K; some fibre in the skin.	**Weight loss:** useful for meal volume and hydration, although not especially nutrient-dense on its own.
Onion and spring onion	Fibre, including prebiotic carbohydrates, and plant compounds.	**Weight loss:** flavour without many calories. Can trigger bloating in people sensitive to these carbohydrates.
Garlic	Sulfur-containing compounds; useful mainly as a flavouring at normal serving sizes.	**Either:** helps flavour meals without rich sauces. It is not a weight-loss medicine.
Ginger	Gingerols and other plant compounds; may help nausea in some circumstances.	**Either:** useful flavouring, with little effect on calories in normal amounts.
Green and red chillies	Vitamin C and carotenoids; hot varieties contain capsaicin.	**Either:** any effect on calorie burning is too small to rely on for weight loss.
Mint and coriander leaves	Small amounts of vitamins and plant compounds at typical serving sizes.	**Either:** add flavour to salads, chutneys and curries. They do not cause meaningful weight loss by themselves.

Dried vegetables: Dried eggplant, bottle gourd, kohlrabi and lotus stem retain some fibre and minerals, but drying can reduce vitamin C. Compare portions **after rehydration**; dried foods are concentrated by weight.

Fruits and their benefits

Whole fruit generally provides more fibre and is more filling than juice. Most people can include fruit while losing weight.

Fruit	Main nutritional benefits	Weight goal and other uses
Apple	Fibre, including pectin, and polyphenols; keep the skin when practical.	**Weight loss:** a convenient, filling whole-fruit snack. Apple halwa adds substantial sugar and fat.
Pomegranate	Fibre in the arils, vitamin C and polyphenols.	**Either:** whole arils are more filling than juice or sweetened sharbat.
Fresh apricot	Beta-carotene, potassium and fibre.	**Weight loss:** relatively low-calorie whole fruit.
Dried apricot	Concentrated fibre, potassium and some iron.	**Weight gain or compact energy:** easy to eat in larger calorie quantities. For weight loss, use a small portion.
Banana	Carbohydrate, potassium, vitamin B6 and fibre.	**Either:** useful before or after activity. A banana can fit weight loss; larger milk-and-nut smoothies support weight gain.

Fruit	Main nutritional benefits	Weight goal and other uses
Dates	Concentrated carbohydrate, fibre and potassium.	**Weight gain or quick energy:** useful in small amounts. They still contain substantial sugar despite being natural.
Grapes	Water, carbohydrate and polyphenols.	**Either:** suitable as whole fruit; portion into a bowl rather than grazing on a large bunch.
Raisins	Concentrated carbohydrate, potassium and some fibre.	**Weight gain:** convenient extra energy. For weight loss, a small measured portion is easier to manage.
Lemon and lime	Vitamin C and flavour.	**Either:** useful instead of sugary dressings. Lemon water does not burn fat.
Orange and sweet lime	Vitamin C, folate, water and fibre when eaten whole.	**Weight loss:** whole fruit is more filling than juice. Vitamin C helps absorption of plant iron.
Guava	Particularly rich in vitamin C, with substantial fibre.	**Weight loss:** a filling, nutrient-rich option.
Pear	Fibre and water.	**Weight loss:** useful for fullness and bowel regularity.
Papaya	Vitamin C, carotenoids and folate.	**Weight loss:** relatively low-calorie. A useful fruit, but not a “detox” treatment.
Mango	Vitamin C, carotenoids, folate and carbohydrate.	**Either:** moderate portions fit weight loss. Larger portions can support increased energy intake.
Watermelon and muskmelon	Water; watermelon supplies lycopene, while orange-fleshed melon supplies beta-carotene.	**Weight loss:** generous volume for relatively few calories.
Berries	Fibre, vitamin C and polyphenols.	**Weight loss:** useful with plain yogurt or oats.
Kiwi	Vitamin C and fibre.	**Weight loss:** a light snack; may also help bowel regularity.
Pineapple	Vitamin C and manganese.	**Either:** whole fruit fits a balanced diet. Its bromelain content does not make it a fat-burning food.
Avocado	Unsaturated fat, fibre, potassium and folate.	**Weight gain or calorie enrichment:** nutrient-rich but calorie-dense. Smaller portions can still fit weight loss.
Coconut flesh	Fibre and fat, much of it saturated.	**Weight gain:** calorie-dense; use moderate portions, particularly when managing LDL cholesterol.

Nuts and seeds used in your recipes

Although these are not vegetables or ordinary fruit servings, they contribute significantly to the nutrition of Kashmiri dishes.

Food	Benefits	Weight considerations
Walnuts	Unsaturated fats, plant omega-3 ALA, fibre and some protein.	**Either:** useful for heart-healthy eating; approximately 20–30 g is a practical portion. ALA does not fully replace fish omega-3s.
Almonds	Vitamin E, magnesium, fibre and protein.	**Either:** filling in measured portions; larger amounts help increase calories.
Pistachios	Protein, fibre, unsaturated fats and vitamin B6.	**Either:** choose unsalted varieties when limiting sodium.
Cashews	Unsaturated fats, copper, magnesium and some protein.	**Either:** calorie-dense; cashew gravies can add substantial energy.
Sesame and melon seeds	Unsaturated fats, protein and minerals. Sesame calcium varies with processing.	**Either:** useful toppings or calorie boosters.
Makhana / fox nuts	Mainly carbohydrate, with some protein; relatively low in fat before cooking.	**Weight loss snack when dry-roasted:** large amounts of ghee change its calorie content considerably.

Beef, sheep, goat, chicken, duck and trout

All six provide complete protein, which helps maintain muscle, repair tissues and improve fullness. Muscle gain also requires resistance training and enough total food.

The figures below are **approximate per 100 g cooked edible meat**, excluding bones, gravy, batter and added oil.

Food	Approximate protein and calories	Main nutritional benefits	Best use for weight goals
Beef	**25–30 g protein; 170–300 kcal**	Readily absorbed iron, zinc and vitamin B12.	**Either:** lean cuts support protein intake during weight loss; fattier cuts provide more calories for gain.
Sheep meat, including lamb and mutton	**24–29 g protein; 200–330 kcal**	Protein, B12, zinc and readily absorbed iron. Fat content varies greatly by cut.	**Either:** trimmed leg is easier to fit into weight loss than fatty ribs. Fatty cuts support calorie gain but also supply more saturated fat.
Goat meat	**25–29 g protein; 140–200 kcal**	Often relatively lean, with iron, zinc and B12.	**Weight loss or lean muscle support:** a useful option when trimmed and cooked with modest oil. Can support gain

Food	Approximate protein and calories	Main nutritional benefits	Best use for weight goals
			alongside larger starch portions.
Chicken	**25–31 g protein; 165–230 kcal**, skinless	Protein, niacin, vitamin B6 and selenium.	**Weight loss and muscle support:** skinless breast is particularly protein-dense. Thigh, skin and rich sauces add calories.
Duck	**23–28 g protein; roughly 190–340 kcal**, depending on skin and cut	Protein, iron, B vitamins and selenium.	**Either:** skinless breast can fit weight loss. Skin-on duck is much more calorie-dense and useful when increasing energy intake.
Trout	**22–26 g protein; 150–210 kcal**	Protein, EPA/DHA omega-3 fats, B12, selenium and often vitamin D.	**Either:** especially useful for combining protein with heart-healthy fats. Bake, grill or poach rather than deep-fry.

Beef, sheep and goat are red meats. For long-term health, keep portions moderate, choose lean cuts frequently and alternate them with fish, poultry, beans and lentils. Limit processed meats such as sausages and cured meats.

How to use these foods for your goal

Goal	Practical approach
Lose body fat	Fill about half your plate with non-starchy vegetables, one-quarter with protein and one-quarter with rice, roti or potato. Measure cooking oil and eat whole fruit more often than juice.
Gain weight	Keep vegetables and fruit, but add larger rice/roti portions, nuts, yogurt, milk and moderate amounts of unsaturated oil. Aim for a gradual calorie increase.
Build muscle	Combine resistance exercise with adequate protein spread across meals. Meat, fish, dairy, beans and lentils can all contribute.
Support heart health	Emphasise vegetables, whole fruit, legumes, nuts and fish. Use unsaturated oils more often than large quantities of ghee, butter or cream.
Improve constipation	Increase fibre gradually through vegetables, fruit, beans and whole grains, and drink adequate fluids.
Support iron intake	Beef, sheep and goat supply readily absorbed iron. Pair lentils and greens with vitamin-C-rich foods. Persistent tiredness or suspected anaemia needs assessment rather than diet alone.

For your Kashmiri recipes, preparation often matters more than the main ingredient: nadru yakhni and deep-fried nadru pakora, or whole apples and apple halwa, have very different calorie profiles. One tablespoon of oil or ghee adds approximately **120 calories**, so measuring added fat can make a substantial difference.